The amazing spreadsheet

Hi, again. I'm glad you're back. In this part of the program, we'll revisit the spreadsheet. Spreadsheets are a powerful and versatile tool, which is why they're a big part of pretty much everything we do as data analysts. There's a good chance a spreadsheet will be the first tool you reach for when trying to answer data-driven questions. After you've defined what you need to do with the data, you'll turn to spreadsheets to help build evidence that you can then visualize, and use to support your findings. Spreadsheets are often the unsung heroes of the data world. They don't always get the appreciation they deserve, but as a data detective, you'll definitely want them in your evidence collection kit. I know spreadsheets have saved the day for me more than once. I've added data for purchase orders into a sheet, setup formulas in one tab, and had the same formulas do the work for me in other tabs. This frees up time for me to work on other things during the day. I couldn't imagine not using spreadsheets. Math is a core part of every data analyst's job, but not every analyst enjoys it. Luckily, spreadsheets can make calculations more enjoyable, and by that, I mean easier. Let's see how. Spreadsheets can do both basic and complex calculations automatically. Not only does this help you work more efficiently, but it also lets you see the results and understand how you got them. Here's a quick look at some of the functions that you'll use when performing calculations. Many functions can be used as part of a math formula as well. Functions and formulas also have other uses, and we'll take a look at those too. We'll take things one step further with exercises that use real data from databases. This is your chance to reorganize a spreadsheet, do some actual data analysis, and have some fun with data.